

The invention that moved people

Elevator

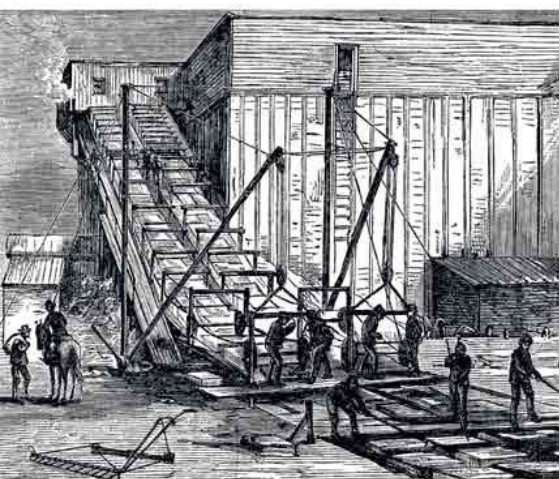
UP in the world

As elevators gave people a safe lift to the top, buildings began to grow taller, and the shape of city skylines changed forever.

Ends of the spring jam into these strong metal teeth if the rope breaks.

By the way...

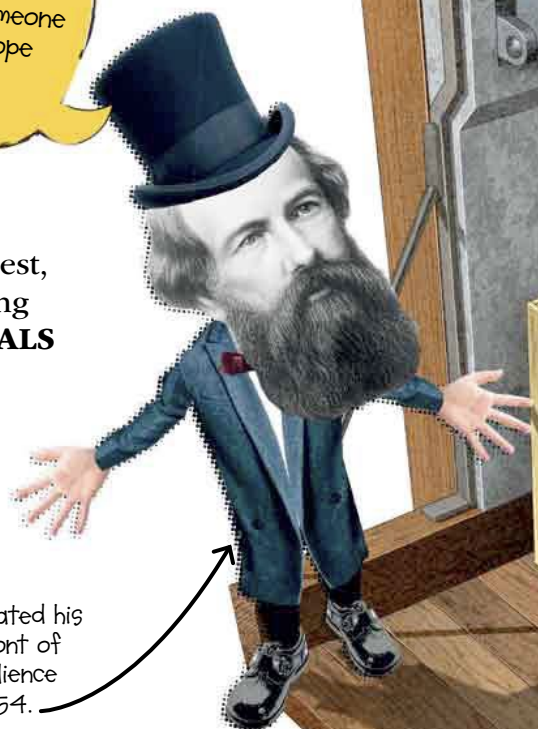
In a dramatic display, I went up in an open-sided elevator, then had someone chop through the rope with an ax!



Steam elevators

Until **steam** power gave everybody a much needed rest, the only way to lift something was for **PEOPLE OR ANIMALS** to hoist it on ropes or carry it up stairs. One of the first steam elevators was used to haul **blocks of ice** from the Hudson River in New York State in 1754.

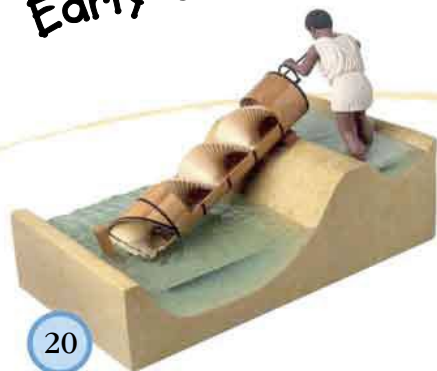
Otis demonstrated his invention in front of an amazed audience at a fair in 1854.



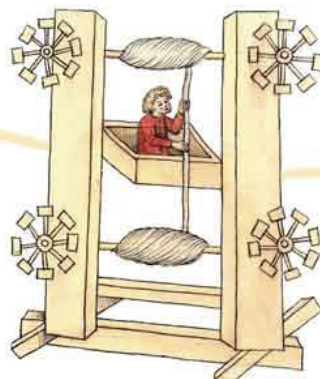
Did you know?

The world's tallest building at 2,716 ft (828 m), the Burj Khalifa in Dubai has a total of 57 elevators and two escalators.

Early elevators



The **ARCHIMEDES SCREW** was an ancient device used to lift water from one level to another. It was invented around the **3RD CENTURY BCE**.



A **HAND-POWERED LIFTING DEVICE** was invented by German engineer **KONRAD KYESER** in the early 1400s.